Statistics / Secondary

Mean, median and range

Different summaries describe different aspects of a set of values. Sort the data before finding the median.

Core ideas

1. Mean = sum of the values / number of values.

2. Median is the middle value in ordered data. With an even number of values, average the middle two.

3. Range = largest value − smallest value. An extreme value can strongly affect the mean and range.

Worked example

For 2, 4, 4, 6, 9, the total is 25 and there are 5 values. Mean = 5, median = 4 and range = 7.

Try it yourself

1. Find the mean of 3, 5 and 10.

2. Find the median of 2, 4, 7 and 9.

3. Find the range of 8, 10, 14 and 15.

Check your answers

1. 6

2. 5.5

3. 7